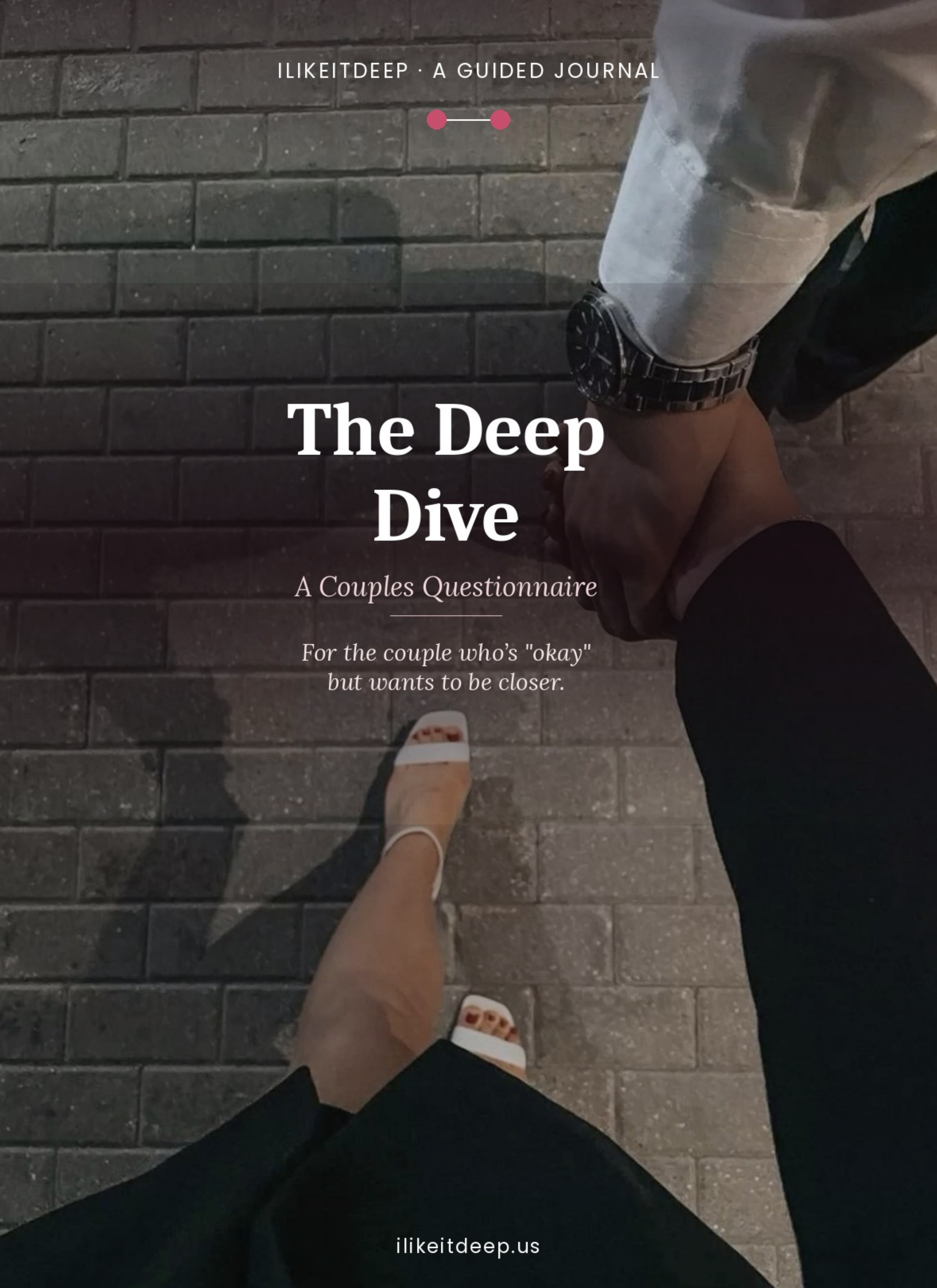


A high-angle, first-person perspective photograph of a couple walking on a brick-paved path. The person whose perspective we are seeing is wearing a black long-sleeved top and white open-toed sandals. Their right hand is holding the left hand of another person. This second person is wearing a white long-sleeved shirt, a black watch with a metal link band, and dark pants. The background is a brick walkway with shadows cast by the couple. The overall mood is intimate and romantic.

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

The Deep Dive

A Couples Questionnaire

*For the couple who's "okay"
but wants to be closer.*

ilikeitdeep.us

The Deep Dive

A Couples Questionnaire

This journal is for the couple who isn't in crisis —
but knows something has gone quiet.

Not a fight. Not a breakup. Just... distance.
The kind that creeps in when life gets busy and the
hard, honest conversations get put off for later.

This is for later.

How to use this journal:

Each of you will need your own copy, or you'll take turns
writing in this one. Answer every question alone first —
no peeking at each other's page. Once you're both done,
move to the Compare section, then the Conversation Script
at the back. That's where the real talking happens.

Go slow. Be honest. This page is safe.

What you write here matters, even the messy parts.

Ground Rules

Read this together before you begin.

- 1. No interrupting until the other person says “I'm done.”**
- 2. Stick to one issue at a time — don't bring up old arguments.**
- 3. Either person can call a pause. No explanation needed.**
- 4. You're allowed to say “I don't know yet” — that's still honest.**
- 5. The goal isn't to win. It's to understand each other.**

This page is safe. Whatever comes up, let it.

Round 1

Check In — the warm-up. Keep it light.

1. **What's one small thing my partner did recently that made me feel loved?**

2. **What's a moment from this past month I want to remember?**

3. **On a scale of 1–10, how close do I feel to my partner right now? Why that number?**

This page is safe. Whatever comes up, let it.

Round 2

The Quiet Stuff — things noticed but never said.

1. **Is there a pattern in our relationship I've noticed but never brought up?**

2. **Is there something that bothered me that I told myself “it's not a big deal” — but it still crosses my mind?**

3. **What's something I need that I haven't asked for?**

Honesty is the beginning of closeness, not the end of it.

Round 3

The Scared Questions – this is the heart of it. Take your time.

- 1. Is there something I've been avoiding bringing up? What am I afraid it means if I say it out loud?**

Round 3

continued

2. Do I feel like I can be fully myself in this relationship? If not, what part of me do I hide?

3. Is there a version of “us” I miss?

You don't have to say it perfectly. You just have to say it true.

Round 3

continued

4. What's one truth about how I feel that I'm scared will hurt them?

Round 4

The Vision — where do we go from here?

1. **What do I want this relationship to feel like a year from now?**

2. **What's one thing I'm willing to work on?**

3. **What's one thing I need from them, clearly and without guilt?**

Compare

Swap books, or read a shared page — before you talk out loud.

Pick 3 answers you want your partner to read first.

This takes the pressure off being the one who has to say something hard out loud first.

Question numbers I want my partner to read:

The Conversation

A script for when it's time to actually talk.

Sentence starters for the hard stuff:

“Something I've been sitting on is...”

“I've noticed a pattern where...”

“What I actually need is...”

“I'm scared to say this, but...”

Remember:

Take turns. Use “I'm done” when you finish a thought.

It's okay to pause. It's okay to cry. It's okay to say

“I need a minute” and come back to it.

What you write here matters, even the messy parts.

Closing

Fill this out together, at the end.

1. One thing I'm going to do differently:

2. One thing I need from you:

You don't have to say it perfectly. You just have to say it true.